Before the test

Tell the participant:

“We’re evaluating the website, not you. Please work through each situation as you normally would and say what you’re thinking. I may stay quiet while you work so I can see what feels clear or unclear. This is a prototype: checkout is simulated, and no real payment will be made. Please don’t enter personal or real payment details.”

Tasks

Read each task aloud without explaining where to click or which controls to use.

1. Find a course

You prepare recurring reports and often have to wait for someone else to retrieve the data. You’re looking for a beginner-friendly course that could help you handle more of this work yourself. Find a course that seems suitable and decide whether you would enrol. Observe how the participant searches or filters, what course information they look for, and whether they can judge its relevance.

2. Review and choose

Before deciding, find out what the course covers, what you would need before starting, and how much time it would take. Tell me whether you would proceed and what influenced your decision. Observe how they navigate the course details and whether the curriculum, requirements, instructor, reviews, duration, and price are easy to locate.

3. Check the order

You’ve decided to take the course. Get as far as you can toward enrolling, and check what you would be paying before you confirm. Observe whether they understand how to proceed, can find the order total and any savings, and feel confident about what happens next. If they reach checkout, provide the synthetic details then; don’t give them navigation hints.

4. Find the course in your learning list

The enrolment is complete. Find the course you enrolled in and work out how you would begin learning. Observe whether they can locate the course and understand the progress and learning-list information.

5. Complete a lesson and check progress

Work through the first lesson as far as this prototype allows. Then check whether your learning progress has changed. The lesson video is a placeholder in this prototype, so assess whether the participant can identify the lesson, mark it complete, move on, and interpret the resulting progress, not whether they can watch a real video.

Neutral moderator prompts

(Use these sparingly, especially when the participant pauses or seems unsure):

- "What are you looking for right now?"
- "What do you expect to happen here?"
- "What would you try next?"
- "What did you expect when you selected that?"
- "Was anything different from what you expected?"
- "What information, if any, is missing for your decision?"

Closing questions

- "Which part of the experience, if any, was hardest to complete?"
- "Was there a moment when you were unsure what would happen next?"
- "What, if anything, would you change to make the experience easier?"

For each session, record the task outcome, notable actions or pauses, participant comments, and UEQ-S responses. Don't record real passwords, email addresses, or payment details.